

Joanne Hoar

Senior Software Developer



linkedin: Joanne Hoar

github: xcodegirl

WHO AM I?

Canadian Software Developer with 20 years of experience in video game programming, scientific modelling and cross-platform development. Expertise in multiple programming languages, game engines and SDKs. Proven track record in leading teams, mentoring developers, impressing customers and building corporate culture. Strong background in C++, Unreal Engine, iOS and Android using agile methodologies and CI/CD. Passion for algorithmic correctness, mathematics, artificial intelligence and nature.

EXPERIENCE

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|--------------------|---|--|
| Jan 2025 – present | Technology Instructor
Instructed 20+ course offerings across Full Stack Development and Data Analytics diploma programs. Delivered live coding sessions, maintained open-source course materials on GitHub, and achieved an average student satisfaction rating of 4.5/5.0.
C# / .NET / ASP .NET Core / Java / JavaScript / React / Git / GitHub / Azure / SQL | Robertson College (contract) |
| 2022 – 2025 | Senior Software Developer
Developed and maintained cross-platform client SDKs for a backend-as-a-service platform used by 50+ published games across 12 platforms including PlayStation, Xbox, Nintendo Switch, iOS, and Android. Engineered CI/CD and TDD pipelines and managed customer relationships with AAA and Indie studios.
Unreal Engine / C++ / Objective-C / Swift / iOS / Android Native / Java / Kotlin / PlayStation / Xbox / Nintendo Switch / Node.js / Groovy / C# / Shell Script | bitHeads Inc. |
| 2011 – 2022 | Co-founder/ Lead Developer
Designed, coded and published eleven mobile games for iOS and Android, from concept and game design through to commercial app-store release. Experimented with cutting-edge device technologies including ARKit and other emerging SDKs.
Unreal Engine / Objective-C / Swift / iOS / Android Native / Kotlin / Augmented Reality / MacOS / Windows | Silicon Hanna Inc. (self-employed) |
| 2008 – 2011 | Tools Programmer
Developed tools that used mathematical modelling to maximize production and improve efficiency for major oil & gas corporations. Led research on a new system that reduced build times by 40%.
C++ / MFC / Windows | Fekete Associates Inc. (S&P Global) |
| 2005 – 2008 | Intermediate Software Engineer
Visualised in-line device data with OpenGL graphics. Implemented neural network algorithms for anomaly detection. Led development of custom web-based GIS reporting software. Improved low-level programming algorithms for data processing.
C++ / C / OpenGL / PHP / SQL / Neural Networks / Borland / Windows / Linux | BJ Pipeline Inspection Services Inc. (Baker Hughes) |
| 2005 – 2008 | Co-founder / App Developer / Instructor
Created and published physics-based games for iOS. Technical writing, web development, Google Maps and Firebase integration and server administration. Developed course curriculum, instructed C++ programming and assessed student work with the Department of Continuing Education.
Objective-C / C++ / OpenGL / Chipmunk / PHP / JavaScript / Firebase / Google Maps / iOS / Linux | SuRJE Software Solutions Inc. (self-employed, contract) |
| 2005 - 2006 | Software Researcher / Lead Developer
Lead developer and system administrator for an iTunes-like music store. Automated DRM encoding and video streaming. Developed a prototype for a Google-competitive search engine.
C++ / PHP / Javascript / .NET / Windows / Linux | PlayStarMusic Corp. |

2004 - 2005	Junior Software Engineer Ported applications to operate under a new GUI library. Developed user interfaces for software life-cycle automation. C++ / Qt / Wx / Shell script / Windows / Unix	Codefast.com
2002 - 2004	Web Developer / VR Artist Designed and developed an interactive online catalogue for the Gerald Hushlak art exhibit with JavaScript-based features. Contributed original generative art from graduate research. Collaborated on a pioneering VR installation using 3D scanning and CAVE immersion technology. JavaScript / C++ / OpenGL / PHP / HTML / CSS / 3D Scanning / VR	Nickle Arts Museum, University of Calgary (contract)
2001 - 2004	Research Assistant Developed graphics software tools using fractal mathematics and biological modelling. Managed network setup and distributed computing infrastructure. Published five research papers and served as teaching assistant across three courses. C++ / OpenGL / PHP / MySQL / Qt / Solaris / Unix / Linux	VLab Computer Graphics Group / Artificial Intelligence Research Hub

EDUCATION

2002 - 2004	Master's Degree Computer Science <i>Thesis Title: Agent-based Development of Natural Transportation Networks</i>	University of Calgary
1998 - 2001	Bachelor's Degree Computer Science	University of Calgary

AWARDS

- Departmental Nomination: Governor General's Gold Medal, Faculty of Graduate Studies, 2005
- Postgraduate Scholarship NSERC D3, Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada, 2005
- Graduate Student Scholarship, Alberta Learning, 2004
- Best Student Paper Award (Co-author), ACAL, 2003
- CPSC Departmental Research Award, University of Calgary, 2003

LANGUAGES

English - native
French - intermediate
Spanish - rudimentary

PORTFOLIO

 [github.com: xcodegirl/career](https://github.com/xcodegirl/career).

PUBLISHED GAMES

- Ragin' Bull - iOS, Android (2020)
- AR Picture Portal - iOS (2018)
- Fragmented Reality - iOS (2018)
- IceCream AR - iOS (2018)
- Jewel Slide - iOS, Android (2017, 2019)
- Word Slide & Find - iOS (2017)
- A Word Theme - iOS, Android (2017, 2019)
- CryptoQuip - iOS, Android (2011, 2019)
- Rafter's Loot - iOS (2011)
- Star Chase - iOS (2008)
- Bitsy - iOS (2008)